

Loveliest of trees

Text: A. E. Housman, 1896

Music: Pierre de Corbeil, harmonized Richard Redhead, 1853

ORIENTIS PARTIBUS 77.77

1 Love - liest of trees, the cher - ry now,
2 Now of my three - score years and ten,
3 And since to look at things in bloom

hung with bloom a - long the bough,
tween - ty will not come the a - gain.
fif - ty springs are lit - tle room,

it stands a - bout the wood - land ride
And take from sev'n - ty springs a score,
a - bout the wood - lands I will go,

wear - ing white for Eas - ter - tide.
leav - ing me just fif - ty more.
see the cher - ry hung with snow.

The musical score is written for guitar and three-part vocal harmony. It consists of four staves of music. The key signature has one flat (Bb), and the time signature is 3/4. The guitar part is indicated by chord diagrams above the staff, showing fingerings (e.g., 2 1, 2 3 1, 3, 2 1, 3 2 1 1, 1 3, 3, 2 1, 3 2 1 1, 2 3 1, 3, 2 1). The vocal parts are represented by three staves, with lyrics written below each staff. The lyrics are arranged in three columns, corresponding to the three parts of the harmony. The score ends with a double bar line.